

Apple Vs Google Maps

Apple has dumped Google Maps and is looking to provide its own maps application
<http://dgit.in/M7gdd1>

**Dual-core Windows Phones**

Qualcomm announced its Snapdragon S4, finally, a dual-core processor for Windows Phone
<http://dgit.in/MjpiPl>

Microsoft's So.cl social network opens to everyone

Microsoft silently launched its social network, So.cl, which had been in development for almost a year. The new social networking website is said to help students connect with each other.

"We expect students to continue using products such as Facebook, Twitter, LinkedIn and other existing social networks, as well as Bing, Google and other search tools. We hope to encourage students to reimagine how our everyday communication and learning tools can be improved, by researching, learning and sharing in their

everyday lives," says Microsoft on So.cl's FAQ page. Pronounced



Microsoft social networking so.cl

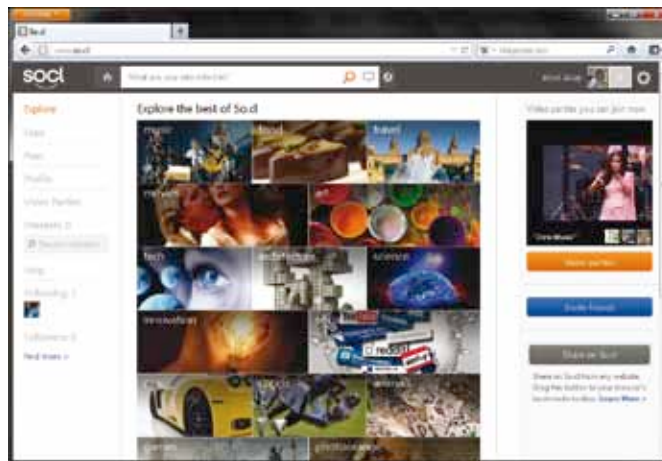
"Social", Microsoft says the social network is not pitted against Facebook or Twitter. Instead, it is an additional layer to the existing social networking concept – and accepts log in via a Facebook or Windows Live account. However, So.cl is quite similar to other social media sites, as

it allows users to share pages of interest, assemble montages of media, and hold discussions. By default, all searches in So.cl are public. But users can mark their content as "private" or delete it as well. The layout looks similar to Google+, with elements from Facebook, Twitter and Pinterest.

Like Facebook, users can follow other So.cl users or follow interests such as art and films. Users can share their activity on the social network with other users. Clicking on the "Everyone" feed, users get to see what So.cl users are searching for and sharing. Users can also choose to post their So.cl activity on their Facebook wall. One of the major highlights of the So.cl is the "video parties" feature, which enables users to create a slideshow of videos. The feature, inspired by YouTube's video sorting, also allows users to skip videos they did not find appealing. 



Video parties on So.cl



So.cl screenshot

Google's transparency report highlights 'alarming' rise in web censorship

Google in its latest transparency report revealed that the number of requests for content removal from the governments of different countries, including the Western democracies, has substantially increased.

Google claimed it had received more than 1,000 requests from the governments around the world to pull down content such as YouTube

videos and search listings. Google added it had removed half of the content requested by the governments.

"Unfortunately, what we've seen over the past couple years has been troubling, and today is no different," Dorothy Chou, Google's senior policy analyst, said in a blog post. "When we started releasing this data, in 2010, we noticed that government agencies from different countries would sometimes ask

us to remove political content that our users had posted on our services. We hoped this was an aberration. But now we know it's not."

For India, Google said, there is a sharp rise of 49 percent in online content censorship from the country. However, the requests made by the Indian government were not published in the company's transparency report. The Pakistan government sought removal of six

YouTube videos that allegedly ridiculed the country's military and senior leaders. Google, however, did not adhere to the request. The Thailand government asked Google to remove as many as 149 YouTube videos that allegedly mocked the monarchy in the country.

In total, over the last six months Google complied with an average of 65 per cent of court orders and 47 per cent of "more informal requests." 